

The 15-Vegetable Small-Yard Starter List

A free printable checklist of the 15 highest-yield vegetables for small backyards, with spacing, sun, and harvest-time notes for each — grab it below before you dive into the full guide.

Why Small Space Growing Fails (and How to Fix It)

Most new backyard growers make the same handful of mistakes: overplanting, ignoring sun exposure, skipping soil prep, and choosing crops that don't actually make sense for tight spaces. The result is a lot of wasted effort and a garden that never quite delivers. The book walks through exactly which vegetables give you the most food per square foot, how to lay out beds so nothing crowds itself out, and how to sequence plantings so something is always producing.

Beyond the Vegetable Bed

Growing food is only half of self-sufficiency. The guide also covers small-space livestock options (think rabbits and backyard hens where local rules allow), simple food preservation methods that don't require a root cellar, water catchment basics, and how to stack these systems so they support each other instead of competing for space and time.

A Realistic Quarter-Acre Plan

Instead of vague inspiration, you get an actual layout and timeline you can adapt to your own yard — what to plant first, what to add in year two, and how to avoid the burnout that kills most backyard homesteading projects within the first season.